

APPENDIX 3.1
(referred to in paragraphs 3.11, 3.57, 3.118, and 4.2)

The surveys

1. In the course of our inquiry we conducted a number of related surveys among manufacturers, distributors and retailers of carbonated drinks.

2. Our most detailed survey was of carbonated drinks manufacturers. We identified 98 companies which were manufacturers of carbonated drinks in the United Kingdom, and surveyed them (with the assistance of NOP Market Research Ltd (NOP)) in June 1990. Seventy-one of these companies replied to our questionnaire. Of those respondents, 14 were identified as having a significant role in the manufacture of carbonated drinks. Most of these had a turnover in excess of £20 million in 1989. These companies were then asked to provide more detailed information. Based on the estimates of the market we received from Canadean and from the BSO, the manufacturers which responded to our questionnaire accounted for 96 per cent of the market in 1989 by value.

3. A survey of distributors was also undertaken, again with the assistance of NOP, and at the same time as our survey of manufacturers. Many smaller manufacturers were also distributors of other companies' carbonated drinks, and their responses were taken into account in the two exercises.

4. Summarised statistical data obtained from this distributors' survey has not been found to be sufficiently robust to be relied upon. This was because, although responses were obtained from each of the major brewers, as well as from other major distributors, symbol groups and cash-and-carry companies, the survey had also included numerous smaller grocery cash-and-carry companies, many of which did not respond. As a result, the overall response rate for this group was only 27 per cent.

5. In a separate exercise, we conducted a survey of major retailers of carbonated drinks. Retail chains with more than 50 outlets and brewers owning more than 200 pubs were sent a questionnaire. A total of 90 questionnaires were dispatched; returns were received from 50 companies, a response rate of 56 per cent.

6. The information obtained from these surveys is reflected in Chapters 3 and 4 and in the appendices to those chapters.